The Consulting skills, masterclass .

10.nov 26 17h13

Memories! Consulting Skills Masterclass was conceived as a "learning from you own mistakes" event. The content, as I look at it now, is heavy. There is indeed quite a lot in it. Conceived as learning by experiencing. Much of my own experience of life, readings, acquaintance with human nature and choices. To achieve this I applied all the ways I knew to make things "stick to the mind"; mainly by means of banalities everybody new to be true, obvious, but also interesting enough to catch attention.

I would start the first day taking time, without pressure to know each other. I would also display what I will do and what we will do together. (this was telling it for a first time from many times to follow). Then, of course, in a wider scheme, I would do what I told, explain each time what I am doing, and then, I would explain what I did, for each important piece of the puzzle built during the day,

Finally in the workshop there is the key component called of course, the Masterpiece. Tis follows the old style of the builders of cathedrals. The learner started as an apprentice, then he was a fellow who travelled to learn by himself, finally to produce a masterpiece proving his mastery. (

The course was following three themes; communication, change, people, the skills most missing in technical education.

It was addressed to senior knowledge workers of Digital, in Europe and diverse other parts of the world and also to top clients involved in the projects of cultural and organisational change ex mergers, acquisitions, crises situations like restructuring and departmental conflicts. 8.49 . In time it became an intervention offered to big clients of our consulting and projects. 10.26 Take communication; (without communication, change is pain, loss, opposition, conflict, fire, destruction, war, We are even able to change ourselves in order not to change..) technicians and managers are often unaware hat communication is not just expressing and transmitting but making things happen with those things and with what you do , your example, what you let happen, what happens in the minds of listeners and participants... The essential way of achieving this is making things simple. The issue is for all understanding what this means. How to have transformation instead of violence. This experiencing and understanding of how complex is to make things simple had deep echo with the participants, some called it life-changing. At least all this learning was to be remembered without effort.

Communication was the foundations on which the other themes were based. (

Session after session, there was a building of sympathy and trust in the teams of participants and a settling of roles of each participant as consultant, observer, leader of the team, representative responsible for communicating tho the plenary or the other teams of the results and decisions of the inner group. (

Many of the plenary reporting and feedback sessions and inter team discussion were conceived as role plays, yet another form of example-giving and communication. While doing all this, I was careful to avoid looking as the one who has power and influence. I knew that doing such a mistake would prepare me to be a kind of scapegoat allowing participants not to take responsibility. (

The big end of he workshop is sudden change. ~~16.55~~ Now participants had learned more than enough, felt confortable with he matter, the process, their roles. Now comes the big simulation or role play called the Masterpiece. The task is to apply what they learned in a fair contest between groups for winning a consulting contract with a big client. The "Client" group was formed of their own group observers and one member of the group represented their consulting firm. Everybody else present were spectators. I was recording everything on video.

The consultant representatives did the best to represent the ir group and win.

However, there is a surprise in the surprise, a change of change in pure N+- 1 style: The client management concludes their offer: As all 3-4Consultancies are excellent, they must join in one team and work with the client, no one team is accepted alone! The representatives would have accepted, but their teams were slower, absolutely against joining competitors. This rejection is a typical and memorable situation. So that regularly the Clients had to declare that all the Consultants lost the contract- Shock! ~~20.00~~ This is the delicate moment when I, the teacher had to de brief. I stopped everything, called everybody around me, sit down on he floor, lower than everybody and explained with transparency what I did, and that the failure was built in as a learning experience, not their fault. ~~20.29~~ As a Change managing consultant you must be able to cooperate with clients and competitors! Like it or not, this is life. What you must learn here is working with people, feelings, interests, misunderstanding, Without this debrief, participants would go back to their rooms and point fingers in frustration.

I caused you to do all these errors. Remember the closed circle rejecting the newcomer, it was by the very instruction to see what they do to enter or to be accepter when rejected. ~~26.51~~

I had to explain all this more than one time, answer questions, listen acknowledge, highlight achievement, validate feelings and arguments, recapitulate... Then, have a drink together, say goodbye, part... 29.43